SPECTRUM HANDBALL RULE BOOK

Handball scoring, rules, and officials

Scoring

In handball, a goal is scored when the whole of the ball passes between the goalposts and travels fully over the goal line. However, a goal is not awarded until the referee has signalled this and they are confident that no rules have been broken.

At the end of the match, the team with the most goals will be awarded the winners. However, if both teams have the same score, official will take the decision whether extra time or penalty shoot to determine the winner.

Rules

- A league game consists of equal 10-minute halves with a 5-minute break.
- A Semi-final game consists of equal 15-minute halves with a 5-minute break.
- A Final game consists of equal 20-minute halves with a 7-minute break.
- A team cannot keep possession of the ball without attempting to attack.
- The start is awarded to the team that wins the coin toss.
- A match begins with both teams in their own half.
- A goal can be scored from any type of throw.
- A player can run with the ball for three steps maximum.
- A player can hold a ball for up to three seconds maximum.
- A player can continuously dribble, providing they bounce the ball.
- A player can take three steps maximum before and after dribbling (no 'double dribble').
- Players are not able to endanger an opponent with the ball.
- Players are not permitted to pull, hit or punch the ball out of the hands of an opponent.
- Players cannot make contact with the ball below the knee.
- Players cannot dive on the floor to regain a loose ball.
- A player is allowed to use the torso of the body to obstruct an opponent with or without the ball.
- A player cannot outstretch arms or legs to obstruct, push, hold, trip or hit.
- An attacking player is not allowed to charge into a defensive player.
- A throw-in is awarded when the ball goes out of bounds and the thrower must place one foot on the side-line to execute the throw.
- **All opposing players must stay 3 m away from the throw-in.**
- All minor fouls or violations are penalised with the awarding of a free-throw which is taken at the place of infringement.

Officials

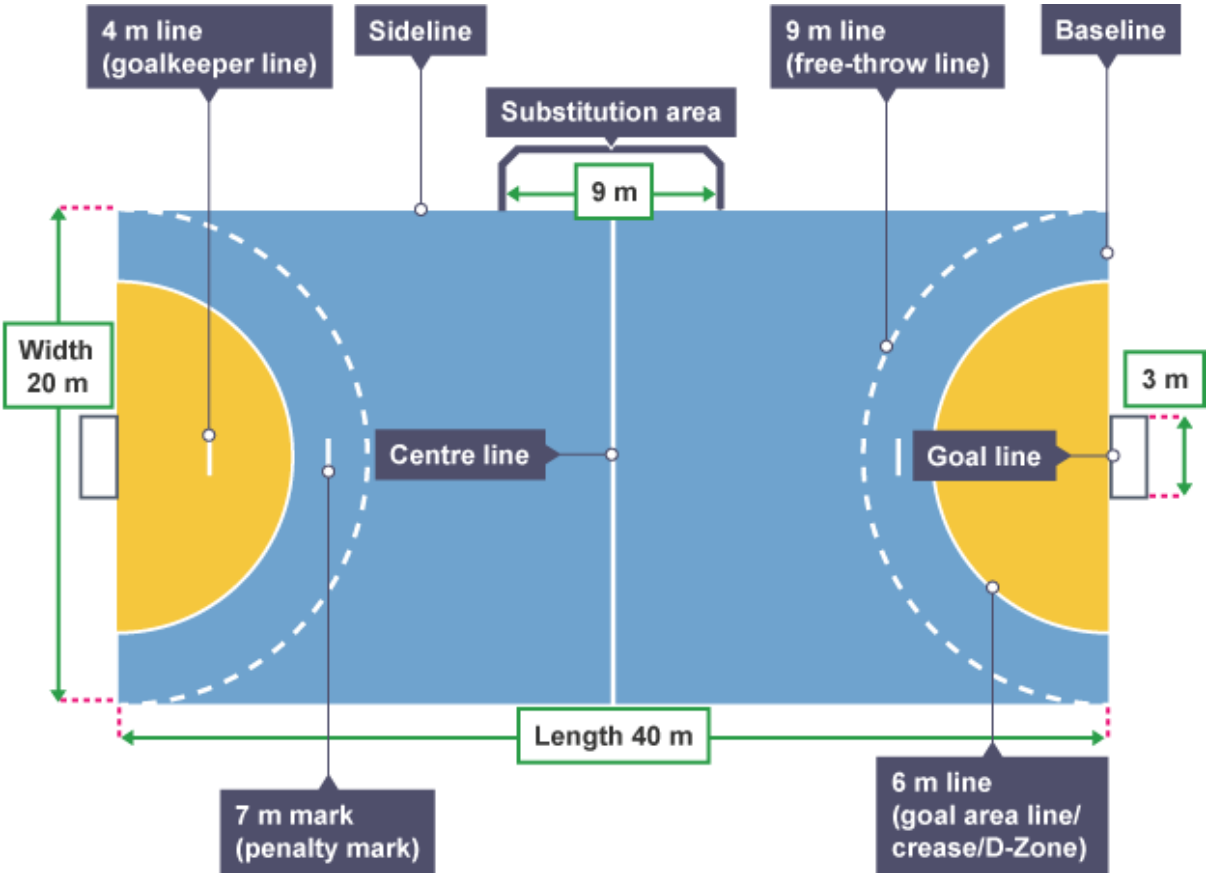
A game of handball is officiated by four officials – two referees, a scorekeeper and a timekeeper. The referees are positioned diagonally on court to observe a side line each and, depending on who is attacking, one is called field referee and the other goal referee.

Officials have a whistle and 18 hand signals to communicate the decision that has been made and use a yellow and red system to warn or remove players.

Handball player positions and playing area.

Playing area

A competitive handball match is played on a large rectangular court that is 40 m long by 20 m wide, with a goal in the centre of each end. A competitive handball court is much bigger than a competitive basketball court – the outer boundaries, called side-lines or touch lines, are longer and the goal lines or end lines are shorter.



The inner markings of a handball court are very precise and support a number of rules within the game:

- Halfway or centre line - this line is exactly in the middle of the two goal lines and has a spot directly in the middle. This spot is used for starting and restarting the game.
- Free-throw line (9 m) – this dashed 'D' shaped line is 9 metres from the outer goal line. The line is used to resume play if an attacking player is fouled within the area.
- Penalty mark (7 m mark) - the penalty mark is used for all penalty throws and is located 7 metres in front of the goal line and is 1 metre wide.
- Goal Area/Crease/D-Zone (6 m) – this area is known by a number of different names. The D-shaped area is formed by two connected quarter-circles, each with a 6-metre radius. The only player allowed in this area is the goalkeeper.
- Goalkeeper line (4 m line) – a goalkeeper is not allowed to pass this point when defending a penalty shot.

Players

A competitive handball team consists of seven players per side, with all players (with the exception of the goalkeeper) being interchangeable during the game. Like most team sports, the team has very clear roles to support their overall success:

- The goalkeeper – responsible for defending the goal.
- Left wing - this attacking player is usually right-handed and covers the left-hand side of the court. In defence, they stand on the far-left side touch line and in attack they provide counter-attacks down the left-hand side of the court.
- Right wing - has the same responsibilities as the left wing down the opposite side.
- Left back - the left back stands to the left of the centre back and tries to prevent the opposition from shooting. In possession of the ball they should initiate counter-attacks and often shoot from distance.
- Right back - has the same responsibilities as the left back down the opposite side.
- Centre back – the centre back stands in the middle of the court and provides both defending and attacking options.
- Pivot - the pivot is an attacking player who travels along the opponent's six-metre line. They must work well with their team's centre back to initiate attacking strategies and are required to shoot in a range of positions. In defence, they play in front of their team and try to close down the opposition's attacks.

LB	Left back	LW	Left wing
CB	Centre back	RW	Right wing
RB	Right back		

Guest Rule

Maximum **2 guest players** are allowed in field as per spectrum regulation, a team can N number of guest player.

Walkover

If team giving walkover for a match, then 5 goal points would award to corresponding opponent team.